

Vrinda Store Sales Analysis Dashboard

1. Project Introduction Questions

Easy way to remember

Tell me about your project = WHAT + PURPOSE + RESULT

Walk me through your project = STEP 1 → STEP 2 → STEP 3 → ... → RESULT

“Walk me through your project.”

Answer:

“Sure. My project is a Vrinda Store Sales Analysis Dashboard developed using Microsoft Excel.

First, I cleaned the 2022 sales data by checking for blank values, duplicates, and inconsistent data. I standardized values like M to Men, W to Women, and One and Two to 1 and 2.

Next, I preprocessed the data by creating an Age Group column with Teenager, Adult, and Senior categories. I also created a Month column for monthly analysis.

After that, I created PivotTables and PivotCharts to analyze sales, orders, gender, age group, states, channels, and order status.

Then, I added Slicers to make the dashboard interactive and connected them with the PivotTables.

Finally, I designed the interactive dashboard and used the results to identify important insights, such as women contributing around 64% of sales, Maharashtra having the highest sales, and Amazon being the top-performing channel.

Overall, the project helped me understand customer behavior and sales performance and provided useful insights for business decision-making.”

Q1. Tell me about your Vrinda Store project.

Answer: “My project is a Vrinda Store sales analysis dashboard that I developed using Microsoft Excel. The main purpose was to analyze 2022 sales data and understand customer behavior, sales performance, order trends, and channel and state-wise performance. I cleaned and standardized the data, created PivotTables and PivotCharts, added Slicers, and finally developed an interactive dashboard to generate useful business insights.”

Q2. What was the main objective of this project?

Answer: The main objective was to understand sales performance, customer behavior, sales performance, order trends, and channel and state-wise performance.

Q3. Why did you choose Excel for this project?

Answer: I chose Excel because it is easy to use for data cleaning, analysis, PivotTables, charts, and interactive dashboards.

Q4. What business problem were you trying to solve?

Answer: “The main problem was that the business needed to understand its **sales performance and customer behavior**. I used the dashboard to identify **which customers, states, and sales channels were contributing the most to sales**, so the business could make better decisions.”

Q5. What was the source of the dataset?

Answer: The dataset was the Vrinda Store sales dataset.

Q6. What was the time period covered by the dataset?

Answer: The dataset covered the year 2022.

Q7. How many rows and columns were present in the dataset?

Answer: “My dataset had **31,048 rows and 21 columns**, including the header row.

Q8. What were the important columns in your dataset?

Answer: Important columns were Order ID, Customer ID, Gender, Age, Date, Status, Channel, Category, Amount, and Ship State.

Q9. What was your role in this project?

Answer: I cleaned and standardized the data, created calculated columns, performed analysis, and built the interactive Excel dashboard.

Q10. What was the final output of your project?

Answer: The final output was an interactive Excel dashboard with PivotTables, PivotCharts, and Slicers with meaning full meaning full insights.

Q11. Who would use this dashboard in a real company?

Answer: Sales managers, business managers, and management teams could use this dashboard.

Q14. What was the overall workflow of your project?

Answer: First I collected and cleaned the data, then standardized and preprocessed it. After that, I created PivotTables and charts, added Slicers, designed the dashboard, and generated business insights.

3. How did you clean the data?

Answer:

“First, I checked for **blank values, duplicate records, inconsistent values, and incorrect data types**. Then I standardized values like **M to Men, W to Women, One to 1, and Two to 2** using Excel’s Find & Replace feature.”

4. How did you create Age Group?

Answer:

“I created an Age Group column using a **nested IF formula**. I divided customers into three groups: **Teenager, Adult, and Senior**. This made it easier to compare customers by age.”

5. How did you use PivotTables?

Answer:

“I used PivotTables to summarize and analyze the data. I used them to compare **sales, orders, gender, states, channels, and order status**. This helped me quickly identify important trends and insights.”

6. What were your main findings?

Answer:

“My main findings were that **women contributed around 64% of sales, adults were the major customer group, Maharashtra had the highest sales, and Amazon was the best-performing channel with around 35% contribution**. Around 92% of orders were delivered.”

7. What was the business impact?

Answer:

“The analysis helped the business understand its **main customers, high-performing states, and successful sales channels**. Based on these insights, the business can improve marketing, manage inventory, and focus on areas with higher demand.”

8. How did you create the dashboard?

Answer:

“First, I cleaned and prepared the data. Then I created **PivotTables and PivotCharts** for different analyses. I added **Slicers** for interactive filtering and arranged the charts and insights on one dashboard.”

9. What challenges did you face?

Answer:

“One challenge was dealing with **inconsistent and duplicate data**. I also had to make the data suitable for analysis.

10. What would you improve in the future?

Answer:

“In the future, I would make the dashboard more advanced by using **Power BI** for better visualization and **SQL** for handling larger datasets. I would also include more business metrics, such as profit and customer-level analysis.”

19. Business Insight Questions

Q213. What was your biggest insight?

Answer: “My biggest insight was that women contributed more sales, and adults were the main customer group.”

Q214. What did you learn about customer behavior?

Answer: “I learned that adults, especially women, were important customers for the business.”

Q215. Which gender contributed more sales?

Answer: “Women contributed more sales, around **64%**.”

Q216. Which age group was the major buyer?

Answer: “The **Adult** age group was the major buyer.”

Q217. Which state performed best?

Answer: “**Maharashtra** performed best in sales.”

Q218. Which channel performed best?

Answer: “**Amazon** performed best, contributing around **35%**.”

Q219. What did you learn from order status?

Answer: “Around **92% of orders were delivered**, which shows good order fulfillment.”

Q220. What did monthly analysis tell you?

Answer: “Sales were mostly stable throughout the year. This helped understand customer demand and plan stock.”

Q221. How can the company use these insights?

Answer: “The company can use these insights to improve marketing, manage stock, and focus on high-performing states and channels.”

Q222. What marketing strategy would you recommend?

Answer: “I would focus on women and adult customers and promote products through high-performing channels like Amazon.”

Q223. What inventory strategy would you recommend?

Answer: “I would keep more stock for products and regions with higher demand and avoid overstocking low-demand products.”

Q224. How can the company increase sales in 2023?

Answer: “The company can focus on high-performing customers, states, and channels, offer targeted discounts, and improve low-performing areas.”

20. Tricky Interview Questions 🔥

Q225. You said women purchased more. How do you know?

Answer: “I found that women contributed around **64% of total sales**. So, I can say women contributed more sales, but this does not prove they were more in number.”

Q226. Is sales percentage the same as customer percentage?

Answer: “No. Sales percentage shows sales contribution, while customer percentage shows the number of customers.”

Q227. Is revenue the same as profit?

Answer: “No. Revenue is the money from sales. Profit is what remains after removing costs and expenses.”

Q228. Why did you use Order ID for counting orders?

Answer: “I used Order ID because it identifies an order and helps me count the orders in the dataset.”

Q229. Can Order ID have duplicate values?

Answer: “Yes. One order can have multiple rows if it contains multiple products.”

Q230. If an Order ID appears multiple times, will Count of Order ID equal number of unique orders?

Answer: “Not necessarily. Count may count repeated Order IDs. For unique orders, I would use **Distinct Count**.”

Q231. Why didn't you use Customer ID for order analysis?

Answer: “Because Customer ID identifies the customer, while Order ID identifies the order.”

Q232. What happens if one customer places multiple orders?

Answer: “The same Customer ID can appear multiple times because one customer can place multiple orders.”

Q233. Why did you use Amount instead of Quantity for sales analysis?

Answer: “Amount shows the actual sales value, so it is better for measuring total sales.”

Q234. Does higher quantity always mean higher sales?

Answer: “No. Sales also depend on the price of the products.”

Q235. Does the highest-selling state necessarily have the highest number of customers?

Answer: “No. A state can have high sales even with fewer customers if customers place more orders or buy higher-value products.”

Q236. Does the highest-selling channel necessarily have the highest profit?

Answer: “No. Profit also depends on costs, discounts, returns, and other expenses.”

Q237. Why did you use a Pie Chart for channel analysis?

Answer: “Because it clearly shows each channel's contribution to the total.”

Q238. What if there were 20 channels?

Answer: “I would use a Bar Chart because it would be easier to compare many channels.”

Q239. What would you do if the dataset had 1 million rows?

Answer: “I would use tools like Power Query, SQL, or Power BI to handle and analyze the large dataset.”

Q240. Would Excel still be the best tool?

Answer: “For very large or complex data, Excel may not be the best choice.”

Q241. What would you use instead?

Answer: “I would use **SQL for data handling, Power BI for dashboards, and Python for advanced data processing.**”

2. Dataset Questions

Q15. What is Order ID?

Answer: “Order ID is a unique number used to identify each order.”

Q16. Why is Order ID important?

Answer: “It helps me identify and count orders during analysis.”

Q17. What is Customer ID?

Answer: “Customer ID is a unique ID used to identify each customer.”

Q18. What is the difference between Order ID and Customer ID?

Answer: “Order ID identifies an order, while Customer ID identifies a customer.”

Q19. What is SKU?

Answer: “SKU is a unique product code used to identify a product.”

Q20. Why is SKU useful?

Answer: “It helps track products individually.”

Q21. What is the Amount column?

Answer: “Amount represents the sales value of an order.”

Q22. Which column did you use to calculate sales?

Answer: “I used the Amount column to analyze sales.”

Q23. What is the difference between Quantity and Amount?

Answer: “Quantity tells us how many products were sold, while Amount tells us the sales value.”

Q24. What is the Channel column?

Answer: “Channel shows the platform through which the product was sold.”

Q25. What channels were present in your dataset?

Answer: “The main channels were Amazon, Myntra, Flipkart, Ajio, and Meesho.”

Q26. What is the Status column?

Answer: “Status shows the current status of an order.”

Q27. What order statuses were present?

Answer: “The statuses were Delivered, Cancelled, Returned, and Refunded.”

Q28. What is Ship State?

Answer: “Ship State shows the state where the order was delivered.”

Q29. Why did you use Ship State for geographical analysis?

Answer: “I used Ship State to compare sales performance across different states.”

Q30. What is the Category column?

Answer: “Category represents the type of product, such as Kurta, Set, Saree, or Top.”

Q31. What is the purpose of the B2B column?

Answer: “B2B indicates whether the order is a business-to-business order or a normal customer order.”

Q32. What is the difference between Ship City and Ship State?

Answer: “Ship City identifies the delivery city, while Ship State identifies the delivery state.”

Q33. Which columns were used for customer analysis?

Answer: “I mainly used Customer ID, Gender, Age, and Age Group.”

Q34. Which columns were used for sales analysis?

Answer: “I mainly used Amount, Date, Month, Category, and Channel.”

Q35. Which columns were used for geographical analysis?

Answer: “I used Ship City and Ship State, mainly Ship State for the Top 5 States analysis.”

3. Data Cleaning Questions

Q36. What is data cleaning?

Answer: "Data cleaning is the process of finding and correcting errors in the data."

Q37. Why is data cleaning important?

Answer: "It helps make the data accurate and reliable for analysis."

Q38. What problems did you find in the dataset?

Answer: "I found blank values, duplicate records, inconsistent values, and some text and data-type issues."

Q39. How did you identify blank values?

Answer: "I used the Filter option to check for blank values."

Q40. How did you identify duplicate records?

Answer: "I checked the data for duplicate records using Excel's duplicate-checking features."

Q41. How did you handle duplicate records?

Answer: "I identified duplicate records and removed them to keep the data accurate."

Q42. How did you handle missing values?

Answer: "I checked for blank values using filters and handled them during the cleaning process."

Q43. How did you check incorrect data types?

Answer: "I checked whether values were stored in the correct format, such as numbers, dates, and text."

Q44. What is data standardization?

Answer: "Data standardization means converting inconsistent values into one common format."

Q45. Why did you standardize the Gender column?

Answer: "I standardized it so the same gender would not appear as different categories in the analysis."

Q46. What inconsistency existed in the Gender column?

Answer: "The same values were written as M and Men, and W and Women. I standardized them to Men and Women."

Q47. Why did you change M to Men?

Answer: "To keep the Gender values consistent throughout the dataset."

Q48. Why did you change W to Women?

Answer: "To keep the Gender values consistent throughout the dataset."

Q49. What inconsistency existed in Quantity?

Answer: "Quantity had both text and numeric values, such as One, Two, 1, and 2."

Q50. Why did you change One to 1?

Answer: "To convert it into a consistent numeric format."

Q51. Why did you change Two to 2?

Answer: "To keep all quantity values in the same numeric format."

Q52. What happens if you don't standardize these values?

Answer: "Excel may treat them as different values, which can affect PivotTable analysis."

Q53. Which Excel feature did you use for standardization?

Answer: "I used the Find & Replace feature."

Q54. What is Find & Replace?

Answer: "It is an Excel feature used to quickly find a value and replace it with another value."

Q55. What shortcut did you use for Find & Replace?

Answer: "I used Ctrl + F and then selected Replace."

Q56. What shortcut did you use for Filter?

Answer: "The shortcut is Ctrl + Shift + L."

Q57. What is Conditional Formatting?

Answer: "Conditional Formatting automatically highlights data based on specific conditions."

Q58. How can Conditional Formatting help identify duplicates?

Answer: "It can highlight duplicate values, making them easy to identify and check."

4. Data Preprocessing Questions

Q59. What is data preprocessing?

Answer: "Data preprocessing means preparing and organizing the data for analysis."

Q60. Why did you create an Age Group column?

Answer: "I created the Age Group column to divide customers into different age categories and make customer analysis easier."

Q61. Why didn't you directly use Age in the PivotTable?

Answer: "Using Age Group makes it easier to compare customer segments like Teenager, Adult, and Senior."

Q62. What formula did you use for Age Group?

Answer: "I used a nested IF formula to create three age groups."

`=IF(E2>=50,"Senior",IF(E2>=30,"Adult","Teenager"))`

Q63. Explain this formula.

Answer: “If age is 50 or above, it is Senior. If age is 30 or above, it is Adult. Otherwise, it is Teenager.”

Q64. What happens if Age = 55?

Answer: “It will be classified as Senior.”

Q65. What happens if Age = 40?

Answer: “It will be classified as Adult.”

Q66. What happens if Age = 25?

Answer: “It will be classified as Teenager.”

Q67. What happens if Age = 30?

Answer: “It will be classified as Adult.”

Q68. What happens if Age = 50?

Answer: “It will be classified as Senior.”

Q69. What happens if Age is blank?

Answer: “Based on this formula, a blank cell would fall into the Teenager category, so I should handle blank ages separately before applying the formula.”

Q70. What is a nested IF?

Answer: “A nested IF means using one IF function inside another IF function to check multiple conditions.”

Q71. What alternative formulas could be used instead of nested IF?

Answer: “We can use IFS, LOOKUP, or a lookup table with XLOOKUP, VLOOKUP, or INDEX/MATCH.”

5. Month Formula Questions

Q72. Why did you create a Month column?

Answer: “I created the Month column to analyze sales performance month-wise.”

Q73. What formula did you use?

Answer: “I used the TEXT formula.”

`=TEXT(G2,"mmm")`

Q74. What does "mmm" mean?

Answer: “mmm displays the short name of the month, like Jan, Feb, or Mar.”

Q75. What will this formula return for a December date?

Answer: “It will return Dec.”

Q76. Why did you extract the month from Date?

Answer: “To analyze monthly sales trends and compare sales between different months.”

Q77. How did you use the Month column?

Answer: “I used it in PivotTables and charts for monthly sales and Orders vs Sales analysis.”

Q78. What problem can occur when sorting Jan, Feb, Mar...?

Answer: “Because the Month column contains text, Excel may sort the months alphabetically instead of in calendar order.”

Q79. How would you solve the month-sorting problem?

Answer: “I would use the original Date field and group it by month, or create a Month Number column and sort the Month column using that number.”

Q80. What is the difference between mmm and mmmm?

Answer: “mmm gives the short month name, like Jan, while mmmm gives the full month name, like January.”

Q81. Why did you convert formulas into values?

Answer: “I converted them into values to keep only the final results and make the dataset more stable.”

Q82. What is the advantage of Paste Special → Values?

Answer: “It removes the formula and keeps only the calculated value.”

Q83. What is AutoFill?

Answer: “AutoFill automatically copies a formula to the remaining rows.”

Q84. How did you apply the Age Group formula to all rows?

Answer: “I entered the formula in the first row and double-clicked the fill handle to apply it to all rows.”

6. PivotTable Questions

Q85. What is a PivotTable?

Answer: “A PivotTable is an Excel tool used to quickly summarize and analyze large amounts of data.”

Q86. Why did you use PivotTables?

Answer: “I used PivotTables to analyze sales, orders, gender, states, channels, and order status easily.”

Q99. How did you find the Top 5 States?

Answer: “I placed Ship State in Rows and Amount in Values, sorted the sales from largest to smallest, and applied a Top 10 filter to show the Top 5 states.”

Q100. What is the difference between filtering and sorting?

Answer: “Sorting changes the order of the data, while filtering shows only the data that matches a specific condition.”

7. Orders vs Sales Questions

Q101. How did you compare Orders and Sales?

Answer: “I compared the monthly number of orders with the monthly sales amount using a Combo Chart.”

Q102. Which fields did you put into the PivotTable?

Answer: “I used Month in Rows, and Amount and Order ID in Values.”

Q106. Why did you choose a Combo Chart?

Answer: “I chose a Combo Chart because it allows me to compare two different values in one chart.”

Q107. What is a Combo Chart?

Answer: “A Combo Chart combines two different chart types, such as a column and a line chart, in one chart.”

**Q109. What does the Orders vs Sales chart tell management?
or Business Impact – Orders vs Sales?**

Answer:

“Sales were stable throughout the year. This helped the business plan stock properly, understand customer demand, and forecast future sales.”

Q112. How would you calculate Average Order Value?

Answer: “Average Order Value is Total Sales divided by Total Orders.”

Formula:

AOV = Total Sales ÷ Total Orders

8. Gender Analysis Questions

Q113. How did you analyze Men vs Women?

Answer: “I compared the sales contribution of Men and Women using a PivotTable.”

Q114. Which fields did you use?

Answer: “I used Gender in Rows and Amount in Values.”

Q115. Which chart did you use?

Answer: "I used a Pie Chart."

Q116. Why did you choose a Pie Chart?

Answer: "Because it clearly shows the percentage contribution of Men and Women."

Q117. What was your main finding?

Answer: "Women contributed more sales than Men. And for men was 36%".

Q118. What percentage of sales came from women?

Answer: "Women contributed **64% of the total sales.**"

Q119. Does higher sales from women mean there are more female customers?

Answer: "Not necessarily. Higher sales could come from more orders, higher quantity, or higher-value purchases."

Q121. What marketing strategy would you recommend based on this insight?

Answer: "The business can focus more on **women's products, targeted offers, and women-focused marketing.**"

9. Order Status Questions

Q122. What order statuses were analyzed?

Answer: "I analyzed Delivered, Cancelled, Returned, and Refunded orders."

Q123. Which field did you use?

Answer: "I used the Status field and Order ID."

Q124. Which chart did you use?

Answer: "I used a Pie Chart."

Q125. Why did you use Order ID rather than Amount?

Answer: "Because I wanted to analyze the **number of orders** in each status."

Q126. What percentage of orders were delivered?

Answer: "Around **92% of the orders were delivered.** Where as returned and cancelled was about 3% and refunded was about 2 %.

Q127. What does a high delivery percentage indicate?

Answer: "It indicates that most orders were successfully delivered."

Q128. Why are cancelled and returned orders important?

Answer: "They are important because they can reduce sales and may indicate problems in the order process or customer experience."

Q129. How can management reduce returns?

or

“What can the company do to make fewer customers return their products?”

Easy Answer:

“Management can reduce returns by improving product quality, size information, product descriptions, and delivery service.”

Q130. If returns suddenly increase, what would you investigate?

or

“If many more customers suddenly start returning products, what would you check to find the reason?”

Easy Answer:

“I would check product quality, size problems, product information, delivery issues, and customer expectations.”

Q: What was the business impact of returns in your project?

Answer:

“Returns can reduce sales and increase costs. By checking returns, the business can find the problem and improve the products and customer service.”

10. State Analysis Questions

Q131. How did you identify the top states?

Answer: “I used a PivotTable, sorted sales from highest to lowest, and selected the top 5 states.”

Q132. Which field did you use?

Answer: “I used the Ship State field.”

Q133. Why did you use Ship State?

Answer: “Because it shows the state where the order was delivered, so I could compare sales by state.”

Q134. Which chart did you use?

Answer: “I used a Bar Chart.”

Q135. Why did you choose a Bar Chart?

Answer: “Because it makes it easy to compare sales between different states.”

Q136. How did you filter Top 5?

Answer: “I used the PivotTable filter, selected Top 10, and changed it to Top 5.”

Q137. Which state generated the highest sales?

Answer: “Maharashtra generated the highest sales. Followed by second highest is Karnataka 3rd Uttar Pradesh 4th Telangana and Tamil Nadu .

Q138. What business decision can be made from state-wise analysis?

Answer: “The business can focus more on high-sales states for marketing, stock, and sales planning.”

Q139. If Maharashtra has high sales, what would you recommend?

Answer: “I would keep enough stock there and focus more on marketing and offers in that state.”

11. Age vs Gender Questions

Q141. Why did you create Age Group?

Answer: “I created Age Group to make it easier to understand and compare customers by age.”

Q142. What age groups did you create?

Answer: “I created three groups: Teenager, Adult, and Senior.”

Q143. How did you analyze Age vs Gender?

Answer: “I used a PivotTable to compare age groups with gender and the number of orders.”

Q144. Which fields did you put in Rows and Columns?

Answer: “I put Age Group in Rows, Gender in Columns, and Order ID in Values.”

Q145. Why did you use % of Grand Total?

Answer: “It helped me understand how much each age and gender group contributed to the total orders.”

Q146. What was the major customer segment?

Answer: “The Adult group was the major customer segment.”

Q147. Which gender was dominant among adult customers?

Answer: “Women were dominant among adult customers.”

Q148. How can this analysis help marketing?

Answer: “It helps the business target the right age group and gender with suitable products and offers.”

Q149. If teenagers are low buyers, what could the company do?

Answer: “The company could offer more products and discounts that attract teenagers.”

Q150. If senior customers suddenly increase, how would you respond?

Answer: “I would check which products they are buying and make sure enough stock is available for them.”

Business Impact of Age vs Gender Analysis

Answer:

“This analysis helps the business understand its main customers. The company can target adults, especially women, with suitable products, offers, and marketing campaigns.”

12. Channel Analysis Questions

Q151. What is Channel Analysis?

Answer: “Channel Analysis means comparing sales and orders from different selling platforms.”

Q152. Which channels were analyzed?

Answer: “I analyzed Amazon, Myntra, Flipkart, Ajio, and Meesho.”

Q153. Which channel performed best?

Answer: “Amazon performed the best.”

Q154. Which chart did you use?

Answer: “I used a Pie Chart.”

Q155. Why did you use a Pie Chart?

Answer: “It clearly shows the contribution of each channel.”

Q156. What percentage of sales came from Amazon?

Answer: “Amazon contributed approximately 35%., mytra 23%, flipkart 22%, and etc.”

Q157. What business decision can be made from channel analysis?

Answer: “The business can focus more on high-performing channels and improve sales through those channels.”

Q158. If Amazon is performing well, should the company depend only on Amazon?

Answer: “No. The company should use Amazon strongly but also continue other channels to reduce dependency on one platform.”

Q159. How would you compare channel performance more deeply?

Answer: “I would compare sales, orders, average order value, return rate, cancellation rate, quantity sold, and profit.”

Business Impact of Channel Analysis

Answer:

“Channel analysis helps the business understand which platforms are bringing more orders and sales. The company can focus more on successful channels and improve its overall sales.”